# Week 2 - Assignment 2

## Strategy Card Game Design, GRATIS and Single Player Playtesting

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# Crystals of Wonholdiem

By Airron Kennedy

An All v All Strategy Card Game
for 2-4 Players
Ages 8+

**Game Description:**
Wonholdiem is in trouble! The seven ancient mages who protect Wonholdiem have been captured by Han the devious sorceress of the land. As one of the mages apprentices, only you have the strength and determination to collect the mages crystals in order to set them free and save Wonholdiem.

# GRATIS Outline

## Goals

- Draw and discard cards that you may or may not need.
- Use the strategy cards wisely to collect cards or stop a player from collecting cards.
- Collect the seven elemental crystal cards and exclaim “Wonholdiem”.

## Rules

- Shuffle the deck and each player draws 5 cards.
  - players can hold a maximum of 8 cards in their hand.
- The youngest player starts and the next player is the one to the left.
- At the start of your turn, draw a card.
  - You can choose either to play an action card or end your turn without playing any cards.
  - After playing an action card, follow the cards instructions to finish the action.
- You win after you collect cards all 7 elemental crystal cards and call out “Wonholdiem” (*wan-hold-eeum)* on your turn.
- Only one action card can be played per turn.
- If there are no cards left to draw, shuffle the discard pile and place it in the deck pile.
- You cannot end your turn with more than 8 cards in your hand, you must discard cards till you are at at 8 cards.
- If a player does not call wonholdiem after collecting all 7 different crystals and showing the party, the player must discard 3 cards for their hand and draw 2 from the deck pile.

## Actions

- At the start of your turn, you can draw one card from the deck pile and add it to your hand.
- You are allowed to play one action card on your turn, place the card in front of you so all players can see and after the action, place the action card into your discard pile.
- Action cards:
  - Peep - take a look at another players cards.
  - Magic action - If this card is played, go through the discard pile, select one action card and play it.
  - Trader - If this card is played, select a player. Both players call out an element crystal card that they need, if both players have the card the other one requested, trade those cards, if not, discard this card.
  - Draw two - Draw 2 cards, pick one, then place other in the discard pile.
  - Force to discard - Pick at random 2 cards in another players hand and discard them.
  - Swap - Every player pick one card from your hand and give it to the player to the left.

## Transitions

- Start Game.
- Your turn ends when you complete an action card or simply say “end turn”
- When you collect all 7 unique crystal cards, call out “wonholdiem”.
- End Game.

## Items

- 50 cards in total
- 28 elemental crystal cards:
    - 4 x (Crystal of Earth) cards
    - 4 x (Crystal of Fire) cards
    - 4 x (Crystal of Water) cards
    - 4 x (Crystal of Wind) cards
    - 4 x (Crystal of Light) cards
    - 4 x (Crystal of Darkness) cards
    - 4 x (Crystal of Grass) cards

- 22 Action cards:
    - 7 x Peep cards
    - 3 x Magic action cards
    - 4 x Trader cards
    - 3 x Swap cards
    - 3 x Draw 2 cards
    - 2 x Force to discard cards

## Setup

- There will be a deck pile and discard pile.
- Both players will take a turn shuffling the deck.
- Youngest player goes first.

# Identify Meaningful Choices

## Meaningful Choices

**Meaningful Choice #1, playing an action card.**

- Playing an action card allows the player to use the cards he/she has at their disposal in a strategic way. Players can hold onto action cards as long as they have less than 8 cards in their hand to use them at crucial times in the game to give yourself an advantage or put other players at a disadvantage.
- Action cards can be played on your turn, after you have drawn one from the deck.

**Meaningful Choice #2, discarding cards.**

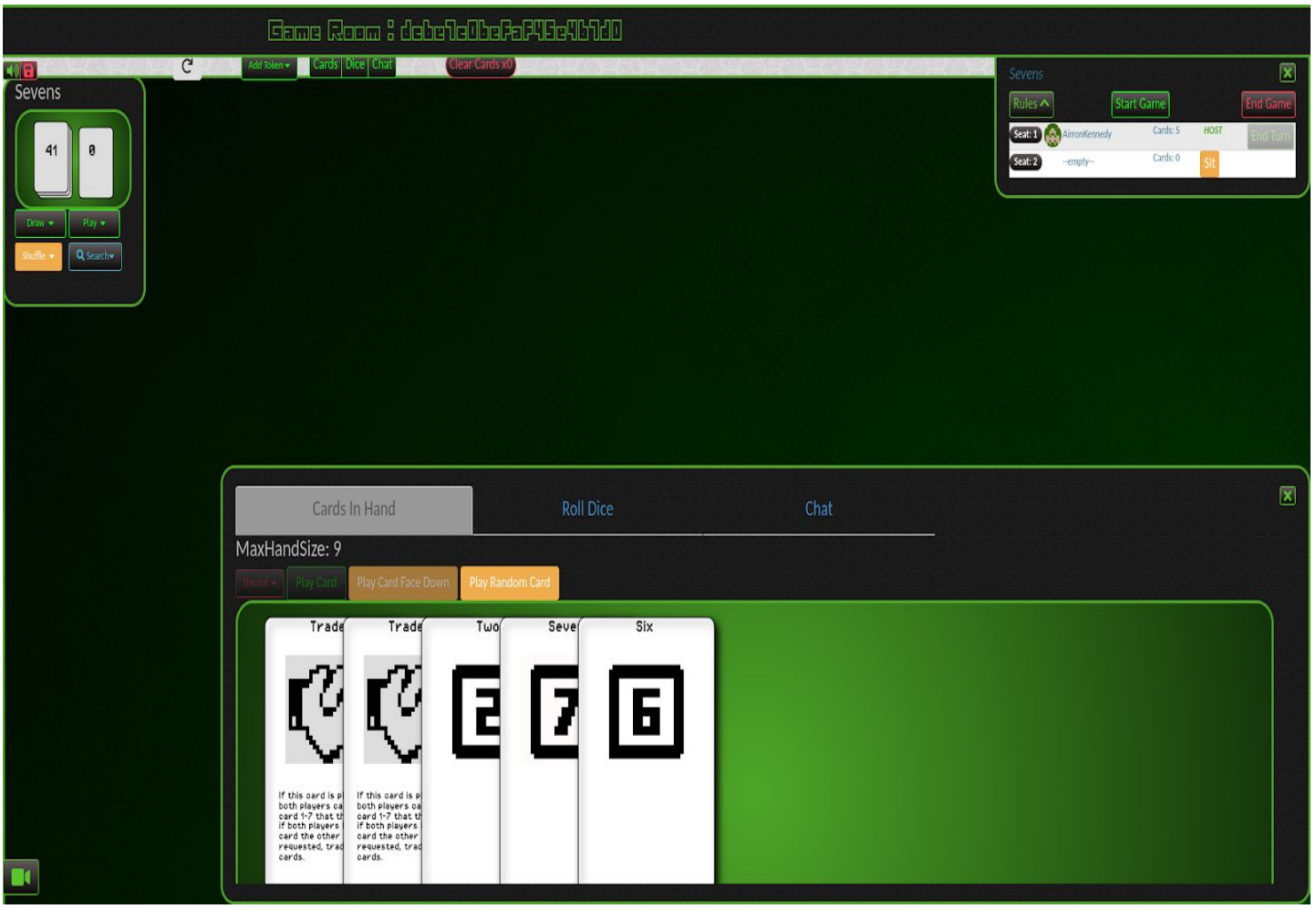
- Players are forced to discard cards after 8 cards but the cards they discard are up to the player, this allows the player to decide what action cards are best suited for the game. Players will find that action cards vary on usefulness depending on their position in the game (in the lead or behind) so knowing what cards you want to keep is crucial.
- This choice occurs after you have more than 8 cards and any given point in the game.

## **Explanation** (answer in at least **one paragraph**)

How do the Meaningful Choices listed above impact your game? How do they improve the gameplay? What would the gameplay be like without these choices?

The meaningful choice in my game is the bread and butter of the strategy you can create. Whether it is discarding cards you don't need to save better ones or playing action cards at crucial times to help yourself or create discord for others, your decisions should be thought out and not taken lightly. These meaningful choices improve the game because players can stop a player from simply getting an easy hand and collecting the few remaining crystals they need. Without The meaningful choices, players would simply collect cards by random until someone was luckier than the others and got all 7 crystals.

# Single Player Playtest #1 Photo


Game Room : debe7e0beFaF45e4b7d0
Add Token
Cards
Dice
Chat
Clear Cards x0
Sevens
41
0
Draw
Play
Shuffle
Search
Sevens
Rules
Start Game
End Game
Seat: 1
AironKennedy
Cards: 5
HOST
End Turn
Seat: 2
--empty--
Cards: 0
Sit
Cards In Hand
Roll Dice
Chat
MaxHandSize: 9
Discard
Play Card
Play Card Face Down
Play Random Card
Trade
Trade
Two
Seve
Six

# Single Player Playtest #1 Questionnaire

(at least **one paragraph per question**)

| 1. In 2 or 3 sentences, how would you quickly (but accurately) describe your game to others? |
| --- |
| Sevens is an all v all Strategy Card Game where the goal is to collect cards 1-7 before the other players do. Players can use action cards to hinder other players or to give you an advantage when collecting the cards in your hand. |

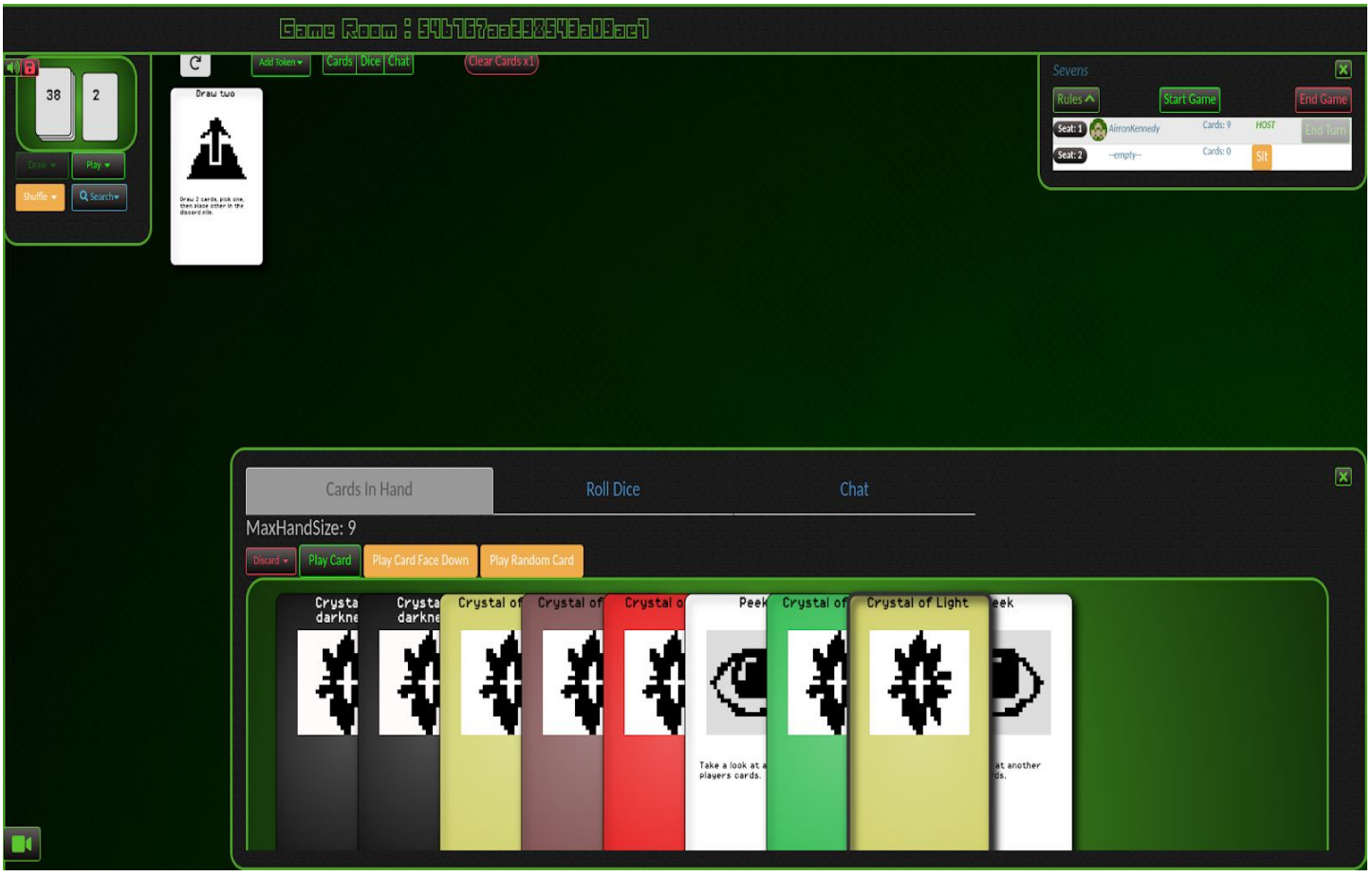
| 2. Did you run into any loopholes or dominant strategies with your design? If so, how did you alter the design to fix these issues? If not, what about your design prevented those loopholes? |
| --- |
| After running a couple of games, I realized a couple of the cards I made came up to often and could be abused to ruin another players experience. This was most common with the “Force to discard” card which forced a player to discard 2 of their cards. To change this, I altered the amount of certain action cards to players couldn't abuse the high rate at which these cards were drawn. Doing this takes away moments where players can gang up on the leading player with a bunch of “Force to discard” cards. |

| 3. What are some of your thoughts on your design? Did the mechanics you made on paper translate well when actually playing the game? *For example: What were the most used actions, least used actions?* |
| --- |
| I liked the idea of my design because it allowed players to easily understand the concept but still provide strategy to play your hands to the best of your ability. The action cards could help a player catch up and force another player to fall back so no one was too far ahead. The mechanics I wrote down on paper when coming up with designs worked well with actually playing because I was able to incorporate all mechanics using “gamestructor”. The most used action i found was using the “Peep” card as it has the highest chance of receiving from a draw in the game. |

| 4. Did the player choices in your game feel meaningful? If so, how were they meaningful? If not, why not? What can you do to improve the meaningful choices available to the player? |
| --- |
| The player choices are meaningful as they provide the players which choices to control the flow of the game. I find that the meaningful choices in my game provides players with strategy if used at optimal times. Some cards you want to hold till later in the game, but at the same time as you collect your number cards you're forced to discard action cards in your hand that might be useful. |

| 5. How long did your game setup take? How was the presentation and usability of your materials? What improvements can you make for the next playtest to go more smoothly and look more professional? *For example: did you use card sleeves, were you trying to shuffle loose leaf paper?* |
| --- |
| Creating my game on “Gamestructor” was much easier than I expected, the ability to create your own cards is amazing. It took me about an hour or 2 to create all the cards, deck, and game. Improvements for my next play test should be updated colors and refining the card descriptions making them more user friendly. Also putting the action cards in the action column will provide players with a better understanding on what to expect during the game. |

# Single Player Playtest #2 Photo



# Single Player Playtest #2 Questionnaire

(at least **one paragraph per question**)

1. After a second playthrough, did you run into any new loopholes or dominant strategies with your design? If so, how did you alter the design to fix these issues? If not, what about your design prevented those loopholes?

During the second playthrough, I felt like the dominant strategy I found in the first playthrough was negated due to the fact that I adjusted the amount of action cards there were in the deck, but by doing that, I felt like I didn't get enough action cards late game that i needed for strategy. Because of this, I changed some of the rates at which you get certain action cards in hopes to have a more balanced game.

2. After a second playthrough, what are your new thoughts on the design? Did the changes you make from the first playtest improve your game? Explain some of those changes and how they improved or detracted from the game experience.

After the second playthrough, I felt way better about the outcome of my game. After adjusting card rates, I still felt like some cards were till coming up too often and cards you need to take advantage of never came up so  i decided to adjust the number of cards again so players behind can take advantage of the “peep” card that allows players to see other players hands. Theme was a huge issue in the first playthrough so i went back and created one so players have a bit of a backstory onto the “why” of the game as well as changed cards to fit the theme. 1-7 changed to elemental crystals to fit into the story better.

3. After your presentation updates from playtest #1, how did your play experience improve? Were there any issues with the user experience? How can you continue to improve the flow of your game for the next test? If you did not make presentation updates, what should you do before the next playtest?

I changed some of the design color elements and changed the numbers to crystals, by doing this, i created a theme instead of simply just collecting number cards. This improved my thoughts on the game and got me more interested in making it. I feel like this change was necessary to make the game more unique and into something I could see myself and others being interested in. Changing the theme forced me to change card texts to make sense. I'd like to change some of the card art for my next play tests because some of them didn't make complete sense when looking at them.

4. Which actions did you use the most, which did you use the least? Were some not used at all? How can you balance out your actions to create multiple, interesting paths to victory?

I used all available actions in my game and found that the action cards are the most useful. Using these cards can be advantageous at any time depending on the scenario. The peep card was most useful because it allows you to see the other players cards. When playing by myself i tried to place myself into a mindset where i didnt know the other players (also myself) cards to try and utilize this card to its maximum potential.

5. Describe the decisions you made throughout a few example turns in your game. Point out each major decision, and quickly describe how that decision was meaningful.

At the start of the game, I drew 2 earth crystal cards. I know by the time i got 8 cards that one of these cards had to go. I also saved some of the action cards i thought would be useful for late game so i could try them out. “Peep” was the first card I drew on my turn so i kept it till I got towards the middle of my game to see what other players had in their hands.

# Week 3 - Assignment 3

## Flowchart, Game Components and Group Playtesting

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# Group Playtest #1 (including the Designer)

### Assignment Instructions

**Introduction to the Group Playtest:**
You are in the heart of the design process for your games now! At this point you should have tested your game a few times by yourself and fixed some of the low-hanging-fruit issues with your design. You should have spotted most logical loopholes and dominant strategies in the previous playtest. Here you be testing your games at least 3 times with groups of other people. You (the designer) will be playing alongside them.

The first task for this week will be to develop a Flowchart of your game rules to help yourself and other players understand the flow of your game. This Flowchart will help identify broken gameplay loops and serve as an overview of a players turn. You will need to **print out the Flowchart** and have it available during your playtests.

To be able to test your game with a group you will have to create the components of your game. You can use anything you have on hand, or can purchase components for your game. Online Students have the option to use gamestructor.com to do this (*refer to the "Putting Analog Games Online Activity" for details on this*).

| **In This Section, You Will:** |
| --- |
| 1. Develop a Flowchart for your game<br>2. Create the physical components for your game<br>3. Playtest your game with a **group** of people (including yourself)<br>4. Take a photo of your playtest including your Flowchart and embed it in your document<br>5. Document your playtest findings by answering the Corresponding Questionnaire |

**What We Want to See:**

Once you have completed a playtest, you should make updates to your GRATIS and Flowchart based on your observations. This should include clarifying rules, tweaks to mechanics and design, edits to card numbers and descriptions, etc.

In this playtest, you will be playing with other groups of people, however you should still playtest alongside that group. This will allow you to help explain the rules and mechanics to the players as you continue to iterate them. *Be sure to take notes whenever a playtester asks you a question! You can easily forget the question if you don't!*

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# Flow Chart

*Please refer to Lesson 3 Outlining and Flowcharts*

**In this section, you will:**

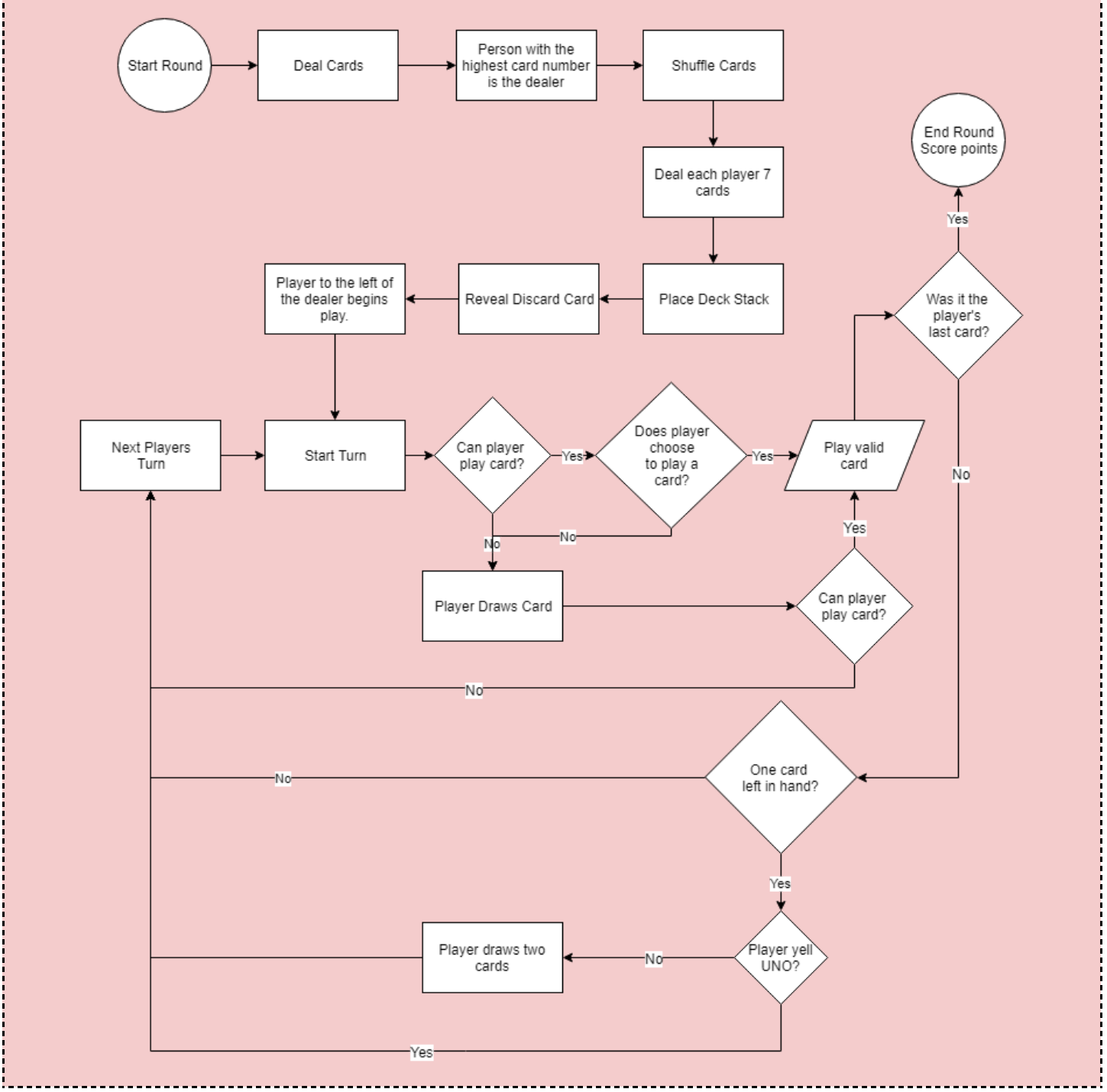
1. Use **draw.io** to create and complete your flowchart that outlines the flow of your strategy card game.
    a. Reference the *Designer's Training Toolkit Videos* for information on how to use draw.io.
2. Embed your flowchart into this document.
3. Print out your Flowchart to use during Week 3's Playtests

**Common Mistakes to Avoid on Your Flowcharts:**

- Crossing lines
- Lines that cross shapes
- Line that are diagonal
- Text that goes outside of the bounds shapes
- Processes have more than one arrow coming out of them
- Flowchart does not have a player choice in it
- Flowchart does not have a game loop
- Process used to end the loop
- Arrows coming out of conditionals or player choices (if more than one arrow) not labeled

# Flowchart

**DELETE THIS EXAMPLE BOX AND INSERT YOUR OWN FLOWCHART IN THIS PAGE AS A .JPG or .PNG**



# Group Playtest Photo #1

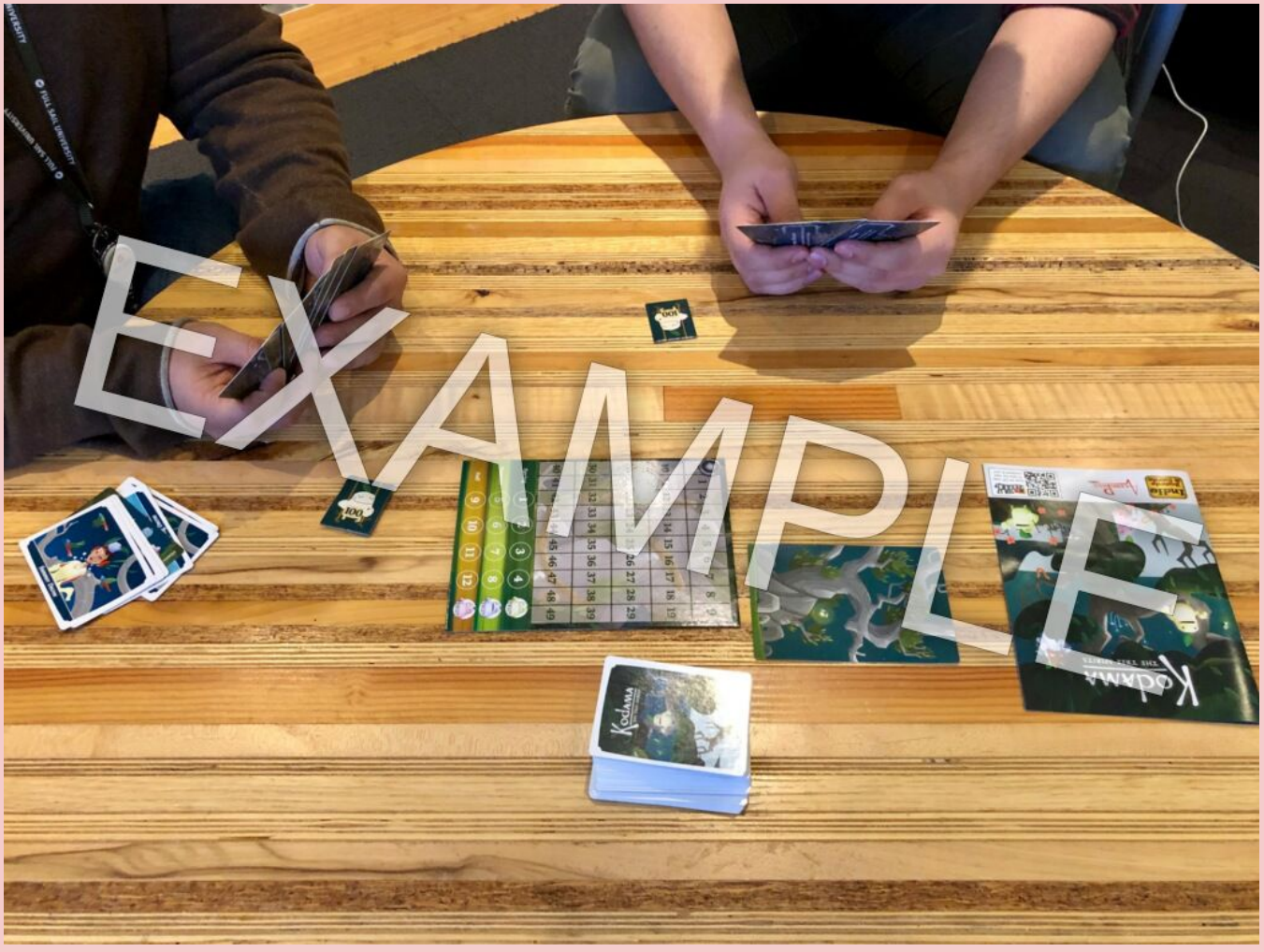
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**Playtest Photo:** Your photo needs to include the following for full credit:

1. The cards and components you have created for this assignment during a game
2. Your Flowchart which is used as a game overview for new players
3. Proof that actual humans are playing your game

**YOU DO NOT NEED TO SHOW YOUR PLAYERS' FACES. HANDS-ONLY (EXAMPLE BELOW) OR BODY-ONLY SHOTS ARE OK.**

**Delete the example photo and replace with your game session photo.**



# Group Playtest #1 Questionnaire

(at least **one paragraph per question**)

| 1. Describe the Meaningful Choices available to your players during this playtest. Did these choices lead to interesting strategies, or was there a dominant strategy / obvious choice always available? Were there multiple viable ways for players to achieve victory? What improvements can you make from these observations to enhance the Meaningful Choices available? |
| --- |
| |

| 2. Did your Flowchart do a good job of explaining the player actions and overall flow of the game? What questions did your players ask you during the playtest about your rules? What steps will you take to clarify those areas? Were there any instances or situations that were not covered by the rules or Flowchart at all? |
| --- |
| |

| 3. What are some of your thoughts on your design? Did your players have any contributions or thoughts on your design? Are you planning on changing your design based on those observations? Explain your decision. |
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# PAUSE

| **Before Continuing to Your Next Playtest:** |
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| Make changes to your game based on your observations from Group Playtest #1.<br><br>This may involve updates to your GRATIS, Flowchart, and Game Components. |

## All Done?
## Proceed to the Next Playtest

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# Group Playtest #2 (including the Designer)

## Assignment Instructions

**In This Section, You Will:**

1. Playtest a second time with your latest rule changes and a different group of people (including yourself)
2. Take a photo of your playtest including your flowchart and embed it in your document
3. Document your playtest findings by answering the Corresponding Questionnaire

# Group Playtest Photo #2

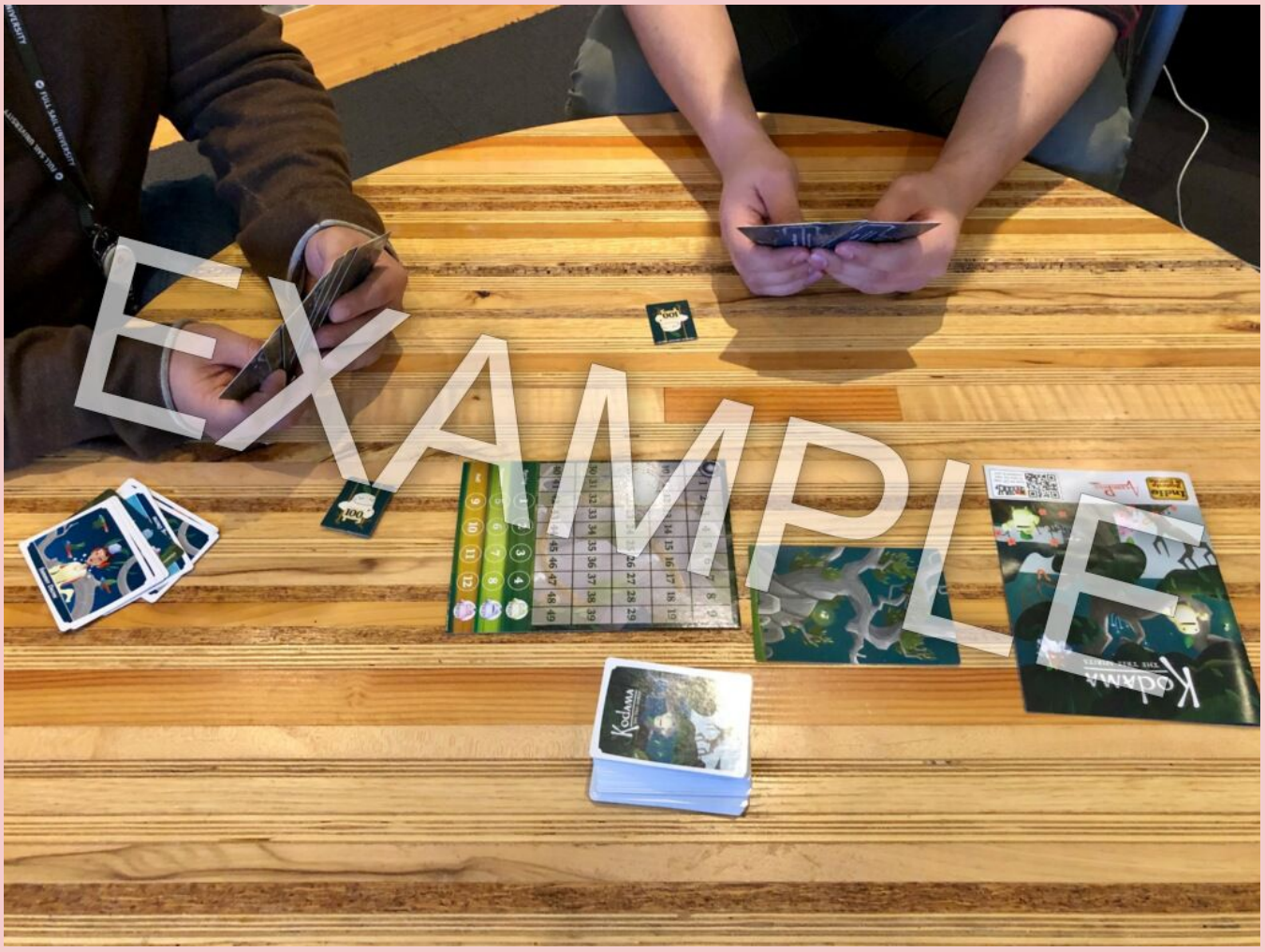
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**Delete the example photo and replace with your game session photo.**



# Group Playtest #2 Questionnaire

(at least **one paragraph per question**)

| 1. After your updates from the first playtest this week, describe the Meaningful Choices your players made this time. Did these choices lead to interesting strategies? Did you eliminate any dominant strategies, or are they still present? What other improvements can be made to the mechanics of the game? |
| --- |
| |

| 2. After updating your rules and Flowchart, did players understand how the game was to be played? Did you encounter new questions that were not addressed in the rules? How can you continue to clarify and simplify the explanation of your rules? |
| --- |
| |

| 3. How did your design changes after the previous playtest alter the gameplay? Were these good changes, or did they negatively affect the game? Are you finding that these iterations are smaller tweaks or larger mechanical changes? With this in mind, do you feel like you are close to the “final design” of your game? |
| --- |
| |

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# PAUSE

| **Before Continuing to Your Next Playtest:** |
| --- |
| Make changes to your game based on your observations from Group Playtest #2.<br><br>This may involve updates to your GRATIS, Flowchart, and Game Components. |

## All Done?
## Proceed to the Next Playtest

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# Group Playtest #3 (including the Designer)

## Assignment Instructions

**In This Section, You Will:**

1. Playtest a third time with a Different Group of People (including yourself)
2. Take a photo of your playtest including the Flowchart and embed it in your document
3. Document your playtest findings by answering the Corresponding Questionnaire
4. Update your Game Rules with your latest changes

# Group Playtest Photo #3

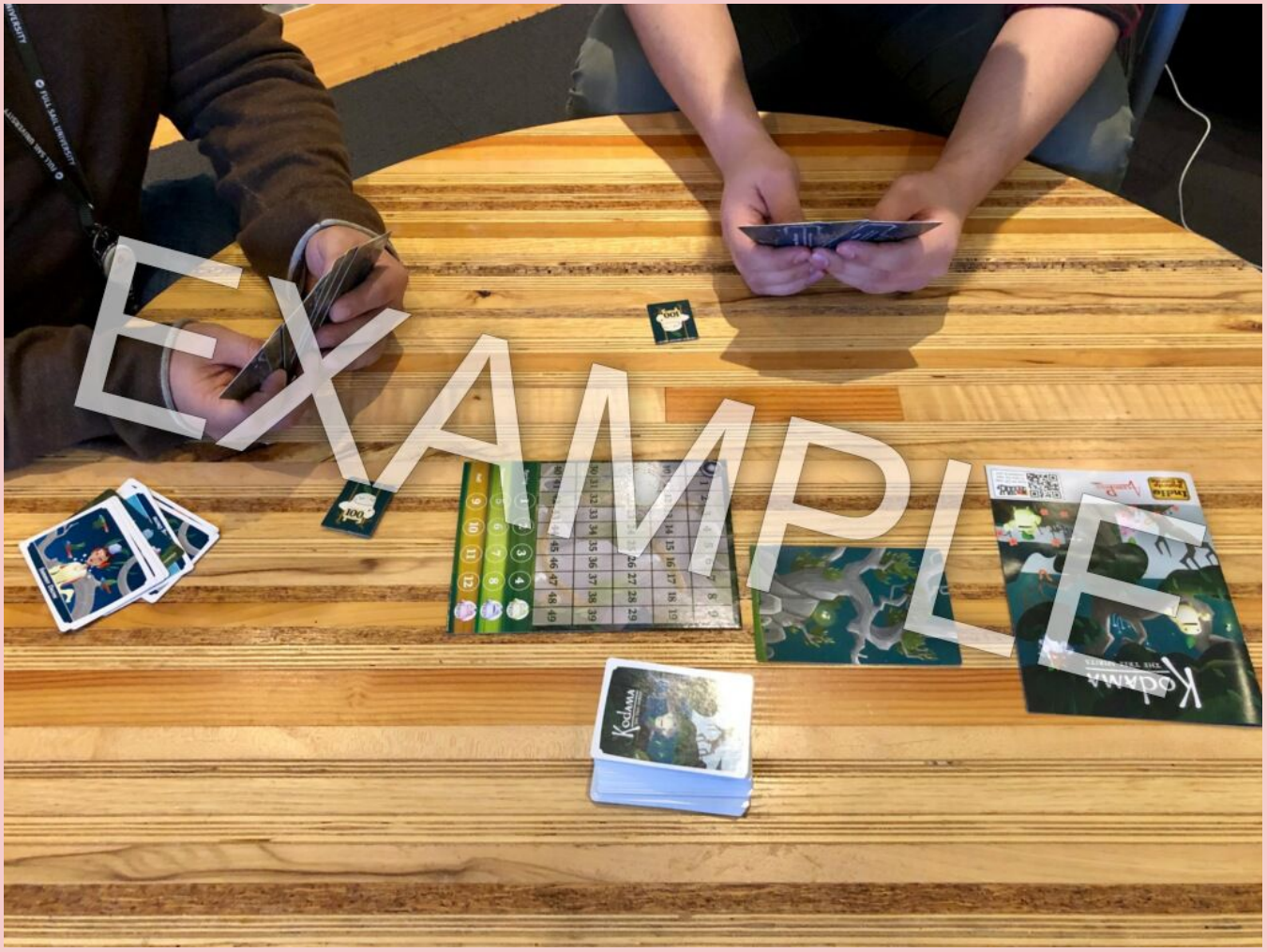
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2. Your Flowchart which is used as a game overview for new players
3. Proof that actual humans are playing your game

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**Delete the example photo and replace with your game session photo.**



# Group Playtest #3 Questionnaire

(at least **one paragraph per question**)

| 1. What type of gameplay emerged from this next playtest? Did you encounter different Meaningful Choices for your players, or were they the same as last time? Is the gameplay varied enough to remain interesting for multiple playthroughs? |
| --- |
| |

| 2. Were you able to explain your game by only reading from the Rules and Flowchart? Did you need to supplement your rulebook with clarifications and examples? If so, how could you incorporate that information into a more effective set of rules for the next playtest? |
| --- |
| |

| 3. How has the game changed since your original design? Reflect back on the changes and iterations you've made since your single player playtests. Think about the critiques and feedback you have gained from other players and how their input has shaped your game. |
| --- |
| |

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**Before Submitting Your Work:**

1. Make sure you documented all 3 group playtests and answered all related in questions in paragraph form.
2. Make sure your GRATIS, Flowchart and Game Components reflect your most recent rules and mechanics updates.
3. Be sure to Delete all of the **RED INSTRUCTIONAL BOXES** for **WEEK 3 ONLY, including this box.**
4. Export your document to .PDF format and submit it with the naming convention ***LastName_FirstName_Assignment3.pdf***




# CONGRATS!
# This is the end of your Week 3 Assignment

# Week 4 - Assignment 4

## Rulebook, Quick Reference, Observed Playtest and Final Reflection

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# Observed Playtest #1 (Designer Observes)

Assignment Instructions

**Introduction to Observed Playtests:**
You are in the final week of the design process for your strategy card game! By now you should have a solidified design that has been well-tested in a group setting. Your goal now is to make sure you have a playable game with a clear and effective ruleset.

To test this, you will be observing 3 new groups of players with your game **without being able to play with them yourself**. They will need to learn the rules from only the materials given to them. You should still iterate on the design of your game as you continue playtesting in this stage.

These playtests will be conducted without your intervention, the players will try to learn your game based only on the rules you give them. Try to intervene only when absolutely necessary. Your playtesters may become angry and frustrated, which is okay. You need to document when and why these things happen in order to fix the problem for the next playtest.

**Before you start Playtesting:**
You will first need to create a **Rulebook** and **Quick Reference** (Cheat Sheet). These elements will help you explain your rules to new players more quickly during this weeks playtests, allowing them to have a faster understanding of your game. Continue on to the sections below for the requirements of the Rulebook and Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet).

| **In This Assignment, You Will:** |
| --- |
| 1. Develop a **Rulebook** to explain the game to players<br>2. Develop a Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet) to help your players<br>3. Conduct and document three **Group Playtests** that you cannot participate in<br>4. Make final tweaks and rule changes based on your playtest observations<br>5. Complete a **Final Reflection** summarizing your takeaways from the design process |

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# Rulebook

Assignment Details

This week you will be taking your revised Rules from the GRATIS section and creating a more streamlined version of a Rulebook. You will be giving this Rulebook to your players for the remainder of your playtests. You should print out the rules before each playtest. Using the Rules provided, they should be able to set-up and play your game without asking you for help.

> *When you purchase a new board game and play it for the first time,*
> *the designer is **not there** to help you learn to play.*
> *You rely on the rules and instructions to learn the game.*

Your Rules will be fairly extensive and heavily iterated upon over the next week. Your goal should be to make the rules and instructions clear, concise, and detailed enough to teach your players effectively without relying on the game designer for help. You should continue making modifications to this section during your testing.

**A typical game rulebook has the following sections:**

1. Thematic backstory
2. List of game components
3. Setup
4. Objective
5. Turn overview
6. Details regarding various game mechanics
7. Ending the game
8. Examples of play

Please make notations of changes and revisions to your rules in the section below the example Rulebook. We want to see that you are testing and revising your documentation properly.

**Below are some Rulebook Examples for Reference**

- Memoir 44 Rulebook Example
- Settlers of Catan Rulebook Example
- Ticket to Ride Rulebook Example
- Pandemic Rulebook Example

# Rulebook

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Under each header below, replace the text in the white boxes with your own information.

## Thematic Backstory

Here you should include your fun flavor text for your game. Set the stage for the players to get them in the right mindset for your card game. Note: This is not a creative writing assignment. Your goal is not to create an amazing story, your focus should be on the card game mechanics. Keep this short and sweet.

## List of Game Components

Here is where you will list the components of your game, typically in bullet form.

*Components Example:*

*56 Game Cards*

- *24 Red Cards*
- *24 Blue Cards*
- *8 Yellow Cards*
- *Instruction Manual*
- *Cheat Sheet / Quick Reference*

## Game Setup

Here is where you will instruct the players on how to set up your game. What are the basic setup instructions?

*For Example: How many cards are dealt out to each player? Where do the cards go? What is public knowledge and what should be hidden? What components do players need at the start of the game?*

## Objective

Here is where you will describe the goal of the game. You should be able to state this in one or two simple sentences.. Your goal needs to be clear to the players so they can quickly remember how to win the game.

*For Example: Players gain victory points by building structures and taking over territories. The first player to reach 10 victory points wins the game.*

## Turn Overview

Here is where you will structure out the overview of a players turn. This is typically done with a paragraph of explanation followed by a numbered list where players can follow along with each step. You do not want to go into too much detail in each step here, instead you can point players to the next section for more details on complicated turn actions.

*Turn Overview Numbered List Example:*

1. *Draw 2 Cards from the draw pile, keep them hidden.*
2. *Choose 1 to put into your hand and put the other Face Down in the Discard Pile.*
3. *Select one of your cards from your hand and play it.*
4. *Resolve the actions on the card and end your turn.*

## Details Regarding Various Game Mechanics

Here is where you should go into more detail regarding your designed game mechanics. Explain the design you have developed in this section, going into more detail when necessary. Page 4 of the **sample Rulebook from Pandemic** is a great example of breaking down the different actions available to a player and how they work.

## Ending the Game

Here is where you will explain the win condition(s) of your game. This should be a clear statement that is easy for the players to remember and keep track of. Looking again to the **Pandemic Example**. Page 7 explains “The players win *as soon* as cures to all 4 diseases are discovered.” This is a simple, single sentence statement explaining how to win the game. They still clarify further to help with some common issues, but the victory condition is concise and clear.

## Examples of Play

Here is where you should outline a sample turn(s) of your game. Typically this is the first few turns that players will take to start the game. It can also be an outline of a more complex turn that often confuses players. **Page 5 of the Pandemic Rules** explains a simple turn at the top, followed by clarification of complex interactions below it.

## Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

In the FAQ, you can list answers to some frequently asked questions from your playtesters. You should first try to write your rules and instructions in a way that answers these questions outright. If there is not a natural place to answer that question and it cannot be solved with a rule change, you may want to include it here.

***Q:*** *This is the first frequently asked question.*
***A:*** *This is the answer.*

***Q:*** *This is the second frequently asked question.*
***A:*** *This is the answer.*

## Documentation Updates (Patch Notes)

Here you will be keeping track of the changes of your Rulebook as it continues to take shape. You should be noting important updates and when they were made. Smaller updates like spelling and grammatical fixes are not necessary to list. Think of this as the Patch Notes to your game, which you keep a running tally of to keep track of your design history. It is important to keep track of the changes you make so that you can reference them for future changes.

*For Example:*

> ***Version 0.2 - After Observed Playtest #1***
> *Clarified the Turn Overview after players were often confused on what was available as an action. Made the Overview shorter and easier to remember, and added further explanation to the Details section.*

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# Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet)

Assignment Details

Before conducting your playtests for this week, you will be developing a small Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet) for your players to help them during the play of your game. Quick References typically provide the players with available actions on their turn, a turn overview, and victory points. Your Quick Reference should be tailored to the necessary information for your game. Obviously this is meant to be a much shorter, condensed version of the rules and instructions containing only key information.

**Below are some Example Quick Reference / Cheat Sheets**

- Coup Example
- Pandemic Example
- Scythe Example

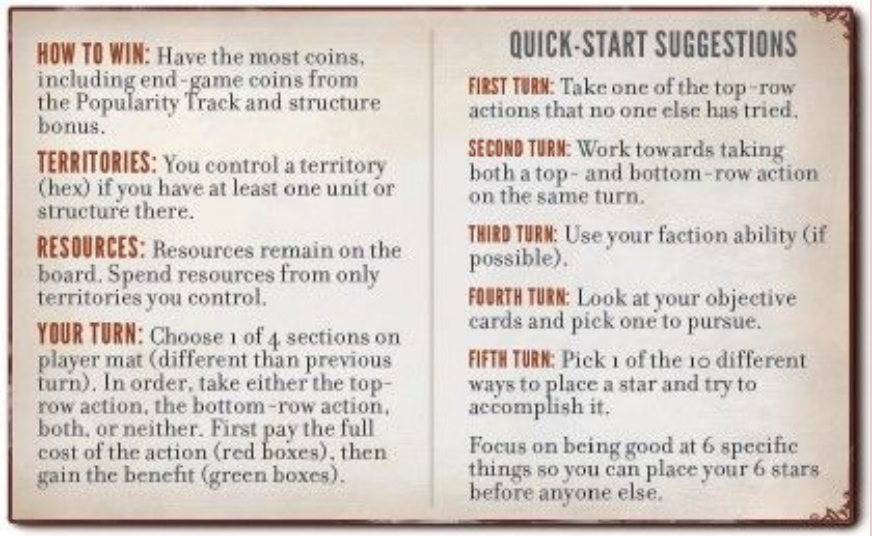
You should be able to print your Quick Reference on a small, half sheet of paper (or smaller) to provide to your players. The goal is to be clear, concise, and realize the most important information necessary for your players to take their turns effectively.

If you are unable to print your Quick Reference - you are allowed to hand-write it. However, the handwriting must be clear, legible, and look professional.

# Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet)

**DELETE THIS EXAMPLE BOX AND INSERT YOUR OWN CHEAT SHEET HERE**

[Example Cheat Sheet / Quick Reference from Scythe]



**HOW TO WIN:** Have the most coins, including end-game coins from the Popularity Track and structure bonus.

**TERRITORIES:** You control a territory (hex) if you have at least one unit or structure there.

**RESOURCES:** Resources remain on the board. Spend resources from only territories you control.

**YOUR TURN:** Choose 1 of 4 sections on player mat (different than previous turn). In order, take either the top-row action, the bottom-row action, both, or neither. First pay the full cost of the action (red boxes), then gain the benefit (green boxes).

## QUICK-START SUGGESTIONS

**FIRST TURN:** Take one of the top-row actions that no one else has tried.

**SECOND TURN:** Work towards taking both a top- and bottom-row action on the same turn.

**THIRD TURN:** Use your faction ability (if possible).

**FOURTH TURN:** Look at your objective cards and pick one to pursue.

**FIFTH TURN:** Pick 1 of the 10 different ways to place a star and try to accomplish it.

Focus on being good at 6 specific things so you can place your 6 stars before anyone else.

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# Observed Playtest #1 (Designer Observes)

Assignment Instructions

**In This Section, You Will:**

1. Observe a group playtest your game **(do not play with them)**
2. Take a photo of your playtest including your Quick Reference and embed it in your document
3. Record how long the game took to play (in minutes) below your Playtest Photo
4. Document your playtest findings by answering the Corresponding Questionnaire
5. Document all tweaks and updates to your Game Rules

# Observed Playtest Photo #1

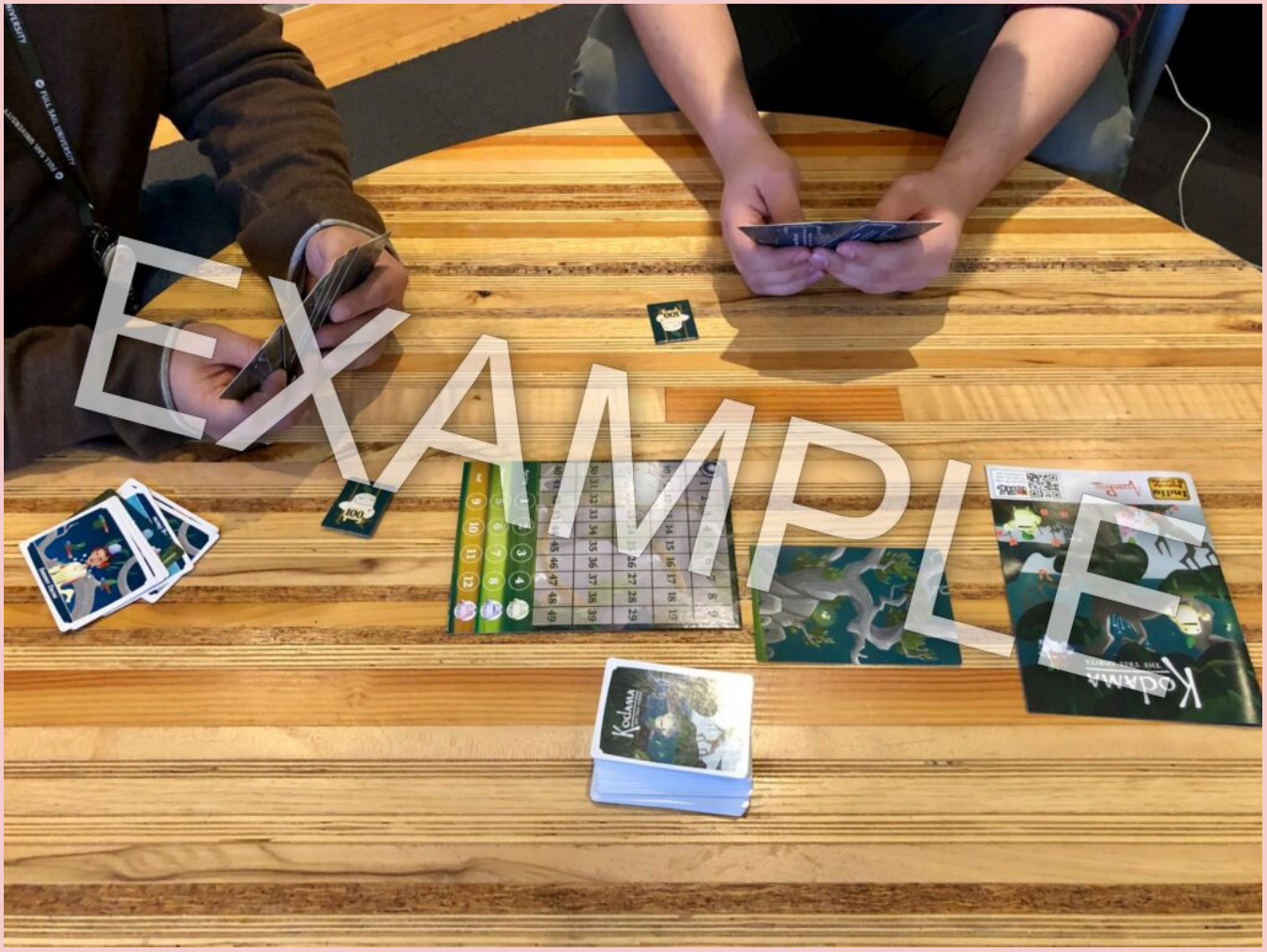
**DELETE THIS EXAMPLE BOX AND INSERT YOUR OWN PHOTO IN THIS PAGE**

**Playtest Photo:** Your photo needs to include the following for full credit:

1. The cards and components you have created for this assignment during a game
2. Your Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet) to help your new players
3. Proof that actual humans are playing your game

**YOU DO NOT NEED TO SHOW YOUR PLAYERS' FACES. HANDS-ONLY (EXAMPLE BELOW) OR BODY-ONLY SHOTS ARE OK.**

**Delete the example photo and replace with your game session photo.**




How long did this playtest last in minutes?

**____ Minutes**

# Observed Playtest #1 Questionnaire

(at least **one paragraph per question**)

| 1. Were your players able to understand the rules and mechanics of your game by reading the rules you provided? What changes would you make to how you present the rules for the next playtest? Did your players use the Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet)? Did they find the information clear and useful? What changes could be made to improve the Quick Reference? |
| --- |
| |

| 2. Tell us about some of your observations from the playtest. Were players getting frustrated, when and where? Were they excited? What were some notable reactions to the game? Try to explain why you think these reactions happened and if they were a part of the design goals of the game. |
| --- |
| |

| 3. How was the user experience of the game? Were players able to shuffle and deal cards easily? Were the descriptions and text on the cards, rules, and Quick Reference clear? What can be improved here for the next playtest? |
| --- |
| |

| 4. Describe the meaningful choices you providing for your players. Are they using all of those meaningful choices, or only some? What changes to your design could further improve your game? |
| --- |
| |

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# PAUSE

| **Before Continuing to Your Next Playtest:** |
| --- |
| 1. Make changes to your game based on your observations from Observed Playtest #1.<br>2. Update your GRATIS<br>3. Update your Rulebook<br>4. Update your Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet) |

## All Done?
## Proceed to the Next Playtest

**INSTRUCTIONS ONLY**
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# Observed Playtest #2 (Designer Observes)

Assignment Instructions

**In This Section, You Will:**

1. Observe a group playtest your game **(do not play with them)**
2. Take a photo of your playtest including your Quick Reference and embed it in your document
3. Record how long the game took to play (in minutes) below your Playtest Photo
4. Document your playtest findings by answering the Corresponding Questionnaire
5. Document all tweaks and updates to your Game Rules

# Observed Playtest Photo #2

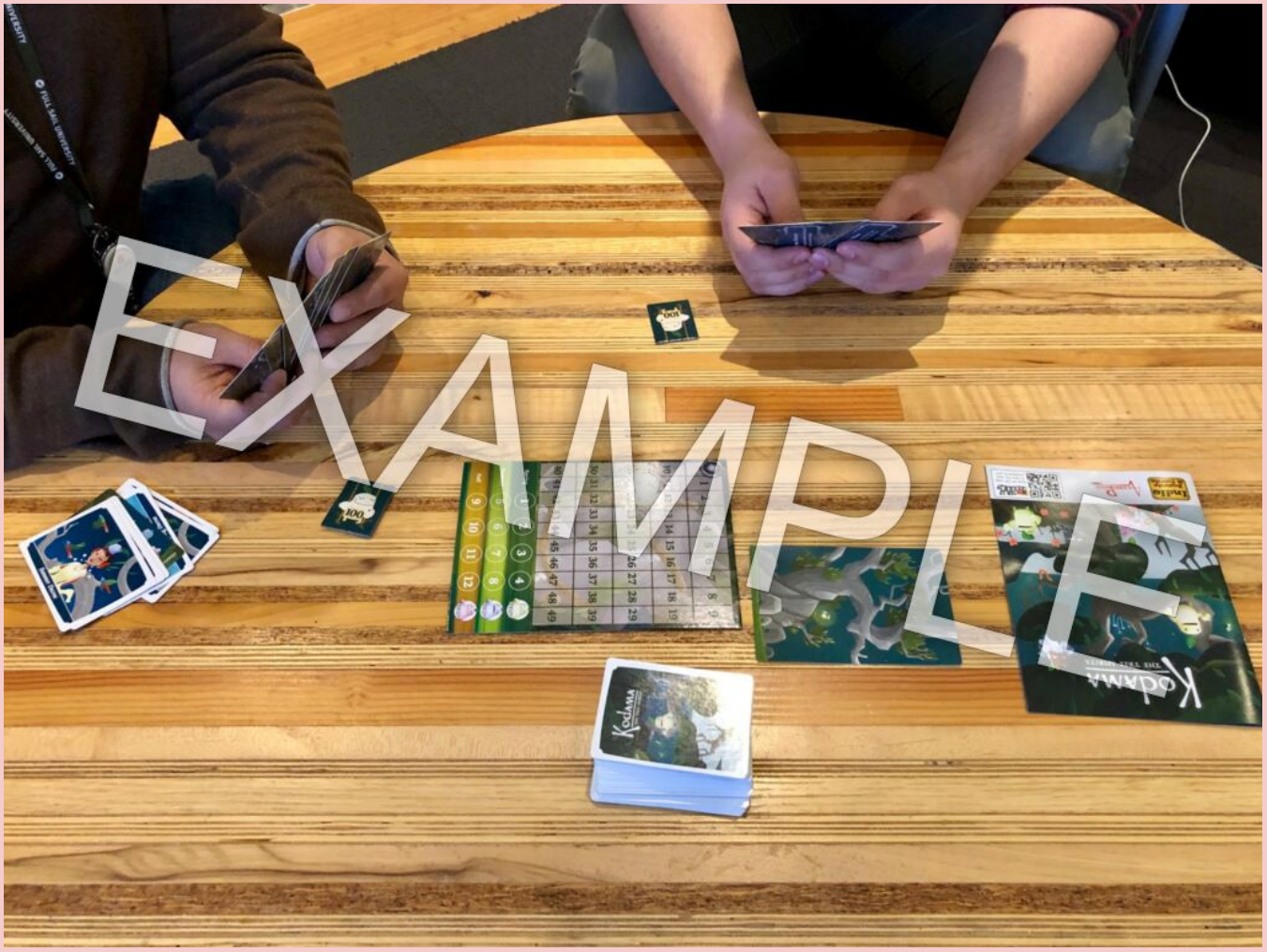
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1. The cards and components you have created for this assignment during a game
2. Your Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet) to help your new players
3. Proof that actual humans are playing your game

**YOU DO NOT NEED TO SHOW YOUR PLAYERS' FACES. HANDS-ONLY (EXAMPLE BELOW) OR BODY-ONLY SHOTS ARE OK.**

**Delete the example photo and replace with your game session photo.**




How long did this playtest last in minutes?

**____ Minutes**

# Observed Playtest #2 Questionnaire

(at least **one paragraph per question**)

| 1. Did your group encounter any dominant strategies during the second playtest? Did you encounter any unexpected player strategies? |
| --- |
| |

| 2. How long did it take for the group to learn your game this time? Were your rules and Quick Reference updates effective? Are there any other iterations you can make to improve the clarity of your game rules? *For Example: Provide a Sample Turn.* |
| --- |
| |

| 3. What sort of gameplay dynamics emerged within this group? How did those dynamics affect the gameplay? Would you encourage or discourage those dynamics for future games? |
| --- |
| |

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# PAUSE

| **Before Continuing to Your Next Playtest:** |
| --- |
| 1. Make changes to your game based on your observations from Observed Playtest #2.<br>2. Update your GRATIS<br>3. Update your Rulebook<br>4. Update your Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet) |

## All Done?
## Proceed to the Next Playtest

**INSTRUCTIONS ONLY**
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# Observed Playtest #3 (Designer Observes)

Assignment Instructions

**In This Section, You Will:**

1. Observe a group playtest your game **(do not play with them)**
2. Take a photo of your playtest including your Quick Reference and embed it in your document
3. Record how long the game took to play (in minutes) below your Playtest Photo
4. Document your playtest findings by answering the Corresponding Questionnaire
5. Document all tweaks and updates to your Game Rules

# Observed Playtest Photo #3

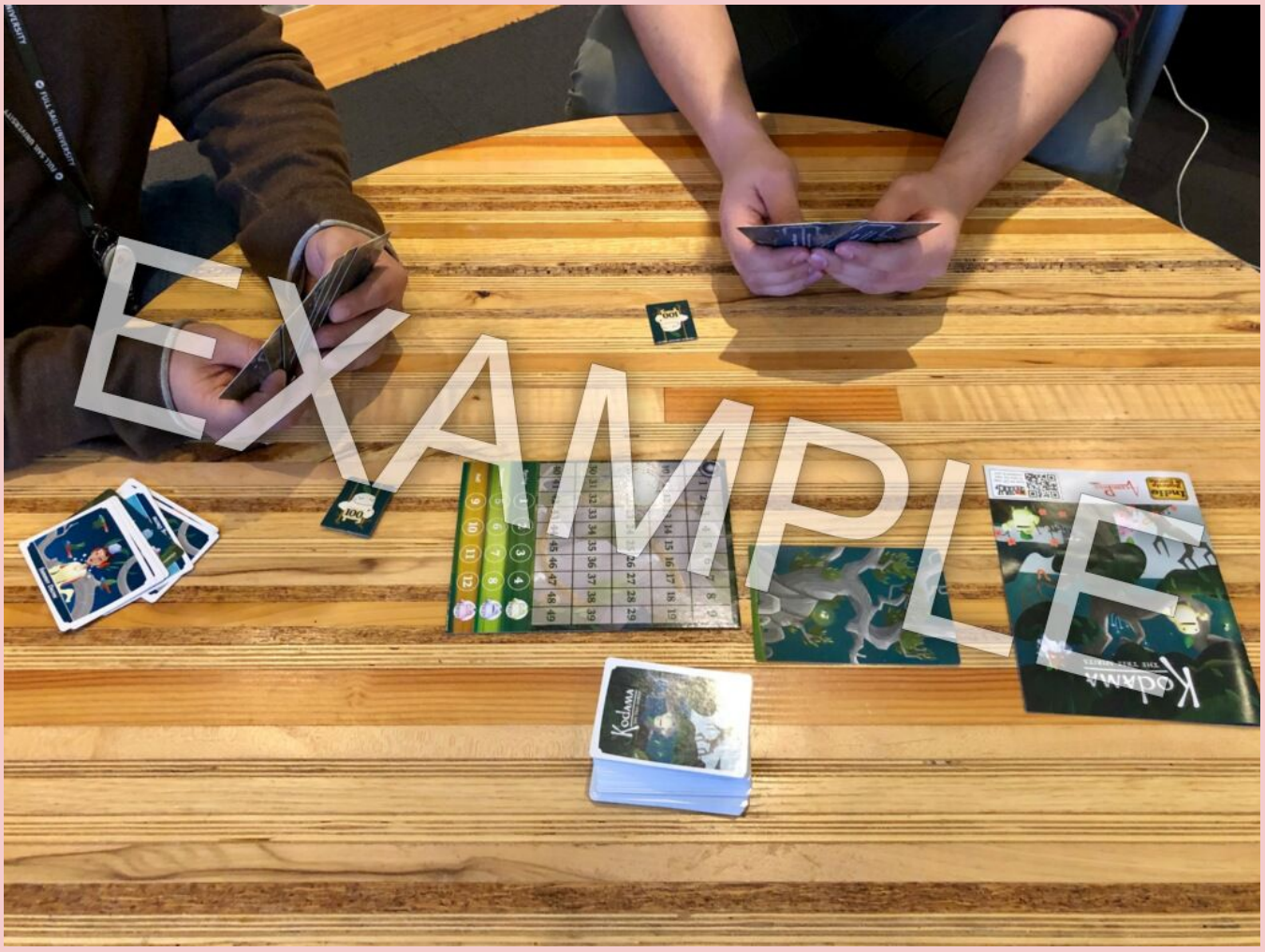
**DELETE THIS EXAMPLE BOX AND INSERT YOUR OWN PHOTO IN THIS PAGE**

**Playtest Photo:** Your photo needs to include the following for full credit:

1. The cards and components you have created for this assignment during a game
2. Your Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet) to help your new players
3. Proof that actual humans are playing your game

**YOU DO NOT NEED TO SHOW YOUR PLAYERS' FACES. HANDS-ONLY (EXAMPLE BELOW) OR BODY-ONLY SHOTS ARE OK.**

**Delete the example photo and replace with your game session photo.**




How long did this playtest last in minutes?

**____ Minutes**

# Observed Playtest #3 Questionnaire

(at least **one paragraph per question**)

| 1. Can you put this version of your game down in front of a group of people, walk away, and have them fully understand how to play the game? If yes, how did you achieve this. If no, what needs to be done to get there?<br><br>*For Example: Are your Rules clear? Is your Quick Reference helpful? Are the cards concise and descriptive?* |
| --- |
| |

| 2. Did each gameplay session feel unique? Were new strategies and interactions happening each time a group played, or was the same strategy used every game to win? How can you ensure that your game remains interested and replayable? |
| --- |
| |

| 3. What feedback did you get from your final group of playtesters? What were their impressions of the game? Did they offer any helpful or unique insights on the design of your game? |
| --- |
| |

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# PAUSE

| **Before Continuing to Your Next Playtest:** |
| --- |
| 1. Make changes to your game based on your observations from Observed Playtest #3.<br>2. Finalize your GRATIS<br>3. Finalize your Rulebook<br>4. Finalize your Quick Reference (Cheat Sheet) |

## All Done?

## Proceed to the Final Reflection Questionnaire

# Final Reflection Questionnaire

(at least **two paragraphs** **per question**)

Here you will record your experience with documenting, prototyping and testing your first game design. Go into as much detail as possible, this is incredibly helpful when you come back to reference this project in the future.

| 1. What did you learn about game design documentation? (two paragraphs minimum) |
| --- |
| |

| 2. What did you learn by using the iterative design process? (two paragraphs minimum) |
| --- |
| |

| 3. What did you learn about play testing? (two paragraphs minimum) |
| --- |
| |

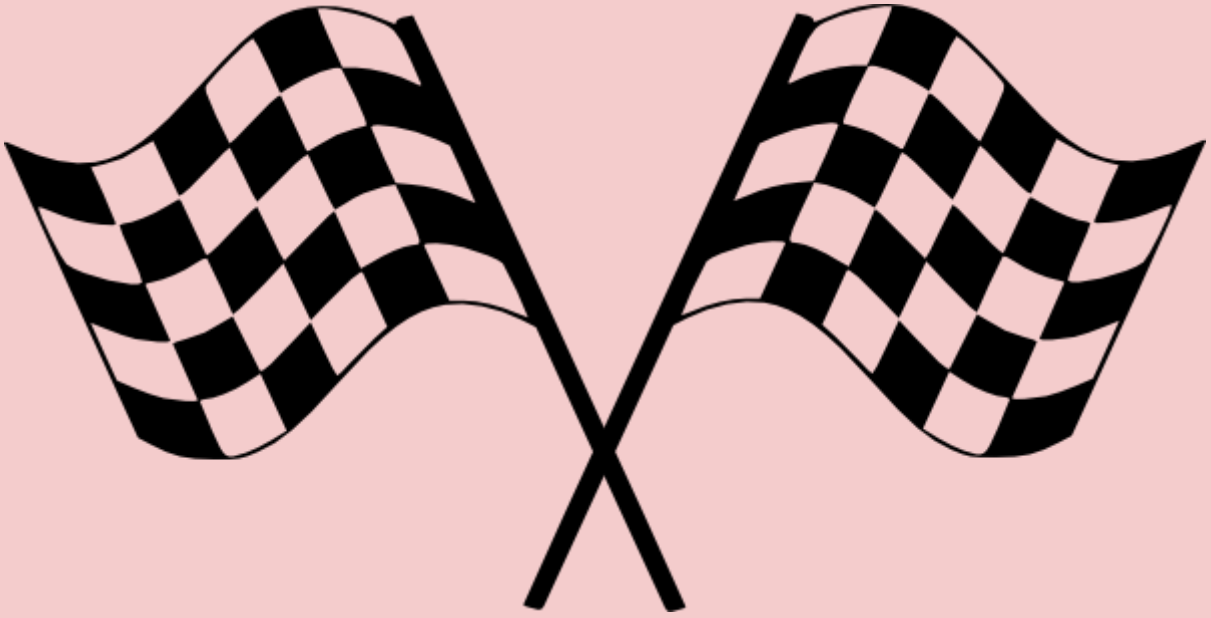
| 4. What did you like about your game? What didn't you like? (two paragraphs minimum) |
| --- |
| |

| 5. How can you improve your process the next time you make a game? (two paragraphs minimum) |
| --- |
| |

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**Before Submitting Your Work:**

1. Make changes to your game based on your observations from your Final Playtests.
2. Finalize your GRATIS, Rulebook and Quick Reference to reflect your new rules and mechanics.
3. Make sure you answered all Playtest Questionnaires as well as your Final Reflection
4. Delete all remaining **RED INSTRUCTIONAL BOXES, including this box.**
5. Export your document to .PDF format and submit it with the naming convention ***LastName_FirstName_Assignment4.pdf***



# CONGRATULATIONS!
# You just completed your Game Design Document!